

Dhāraṇī of the Thousand Ślokas

Śālokaśahasrāvbodhā dhāraṇī · Toh 715 · Derge Kangyur

ཤ་ལ་ཀོ་སྟོ་ལོ་ལོ་པའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 715 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text in Tibetan, associated in Sanskrit with the tradition of Avalokiteśvara and known in English as the Dhāraṇī for Mastering a Thousand Ślokas. It belongs to the broad category of dhāraṇī literature, presenting a brief mantra and accompanying ritual instructions focused on enhancing memory and learning, specifically enabling the practitioner to master a thousand verses in a single day. The text opens with homages to the Three Jewels and to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, invoking his compassionate power as the ritual's presiding figure, and prescribes a seven-day practice of reciting the mantra over water, drinking it, and observing a simple dietary discipline. As a dhāraṇī belonging to the Kangyur, it sits within the canonical collection of Buddha-word and closely associated texts preserved in the Tibetan Buddhist tradition.

This completes the dhāraṇī of the Thousand Ślokas.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Buddha, who teaches without obstruction from every direction. Homage to the noble bodhisattva, the great being endowed with great compassion, Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Vision.

The mantra is as follows: tadyathā — ka ba tsa karṇa la la te svāhā.

If one recites this over water seven times and washes one's face with it, all people will come to rejoice in one's presence.

The ritual for this is as follows: one places water before the presence of the noble Avalokiteśvara, recites the mantra seven times, and drinks the water. In the morning one eats food mixed with milk. If one does this in the same manner for seven days continuously, one will come to master a thousand ślokas in a single day.

The Thousand Ślokas —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-phrase at the end, suggesting this is a fragment from a larger compilation; the final line "The Thousand Ślokas —" is the beginning of a colophon or new section title that continues elsewhere.

The mantra syllables "ka ba tsa karṇa la la te svāhā" are transliterated as they stand and are not translated, as dhāraṇī syllables are conventionally treated as sacred sound-units rather than semantically parsed phrases.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.